

COMPREHENSIVE EVIDENCE-BASED REVIEW

AI Data Annotation Platforms for Nigeria

A beginner-friendly analysis of 9 AI training and data annotation platforms. Covers legitimacy, Nigeria availability, payment methods, earnings potential, risks, and a practical 90-day roadmap to earning remotely.

9 Platforms Reviewed · 20 Data Points Each · 5 Ranking Categories
July 2026 · Research Edition

CrowdGen

Outlier

TELUS Digital

Welocalize

Alignerr

OneForma

Prolific

Mercor

Handshake

AI Data Annotation Platforms for Nigeria

Comprehensive Evidence-Based Review for Beginners

9 Platforms · 20 Data Points Each · 5 Ranking Categories · 90-Day Roadmap

Research Edition · July 2026

Sources: Official platforms, Trustpilot, Indeed, Glassdoor, Reddit, Zikoko, AfrikStories, RemoWork, YouTube reviews, and independent publications.

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1. Platform-by-Platform Analysis

Each platform below is evaluated against 20 specific criteria. Data is drawn from official documentation, independent review sites, user communities, and Nigerian-focused publications. Claims are labeled as verified, community-reported, or uncertain.

1. CrowdGen (Appen)

Website: crowdgen.com

Company Overview

CrowdGen is the contributor platform of Appen, a publicly traded company listed on the Australian Securities Exchange (APX). Appen has been in the AI data annotation industry since 1996 and is one of the oldest and most established companies in the space. The CrowdGen platform connects over 1 million contributors worldwide with AI training projects, offering tasks that range from image labeling to text evaluation and voice recording.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Appen is a publicly traded company (ASX: APX) with a 28+ year track record. CrowdGen is its official contributor platform. This is one of the most verifiably legitimate platforms in the AI data annotation industry.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Mostly yes, but with significant complaints. Appen has paid contributors for decades. However, Trustpilot reviews (2.0/5 rating from hundreds of reviews) frequently cite delayed payments, unpaid qualification time, and sudden account deactivations without explanation. Payments do arrive for most contributors, but the process is often frustrating.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Yes. CrowdGen/Appen accepts contributors from Nigeria. Multiple Nigerian-focused guides (Zikoko, AfrikStories) confirm this. Nigerian contributors can register, access projects, and receive payments.

Country Restrictions

Some projects are geo-restricted. Certain high-paying tasks are only available in specific countries (US, UK, EU). Nigerian contributors typically see fewer project opportunities than contributors in Western countries.

Registration Requirements

Sign up at crowdgen.com with email. Complete profile with personal details, language skills, and professional expertise. No upfront fees required.

Identity Verification Process

Government-issued ID (national ID card, passport, or voter card). Address verification may be required. Tax information (W-8BEN for international contributors) must be completed before first payment.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

PayPal is the primary method for Nigerian contributors. Bank transfer via Payoneer is also available in some cases. Direct bank transfer to Nigerian accounts is limited.

Payment Schedule

Biweekly or monthly, depending on the project. Some projects pay weekly. Payment thresholds may apply (minimum \$5-\$10 before withdrawal).

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

\$3-\$8/hour for basic tasks (image labeling, search evaluation). Experienced contributors in specialized domains can earn \$10-\$20/hour.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$10-\$25/hour for domain-specific tasks (coding, medical, legal). Rare high-value projects can pay \$30+/hour.

Types of Available Tasks

Image annotation, text classification, search relevance evaluation, voice recording, transcription, sentiment analysis, data collection, AI model evaluation.

Skills Required

Basic internet literacy for entry-level tasks. Reading comprehension, attention to detail, and consistency in following guidelines. Specialized projects may require domain expertise (coding, medicine, law, finance).

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Moderate. Registration is open, but passing qualification tests for specific projects can be challenging. Many users report spending hours studying for tests only to not be selected.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

High. Work availability is inconsistent. Projects appear and disappear without warning. Contributors may wait weeks for new project assignments. This is the single most common complaint.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing qualification assessments, inconsistent work quality, using AI tools to complete tasks, sharing account information, VPN/Proxy use (strictly forbidden and actively detected), inactive accounts.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Quality score drops below threshold, project ends abruptly, account flagged for suspicious activity, inactivity for extended periods, policy violations.

Current Reputation

Mixed to negative currently (2024-2026). Trustpilot: 2.0/5. Reddit: widespread frustration about lack of communication, project scarcity, and unpaid qualification time. Historically strong reputation has deteriorated. Zikoko (Nigerian publication) still lists it as a viable option.

Risks and Red Flags

High project instability. Unpaid qualification time (sometimes hours of unpaid testing). Account deactivation without explanation. Low pay rates for basic tasks. Communication from support is frequently described as nonexistent.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Yes, but with caveats. It is legitimate and pays, but manage expectations. Do not rely on CrowdGen as your primary income source. Use it as one of multiple platforms.

Overall Score:
6/10

RECOMMENDED WITH CAVEATS

2. Outlier

Website: outlier.ai

Company Overview

Outlier (formerly Outlier AI) is a platform focused on training advanced AI models through expert-written responses, model evaluation, and reinforcement learning from human feedback (RLHF). It has gained significant attention as one of the higher-paying AI training platforms, with tasks that require writing, coding, math, and domain expertise. The platform is backed by substantial venture capital and works with leading AI companies.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Outlier is a legitimate company that has been reviewed by major outlets and has a functional application process. Indeed reviews (2.4/5, 775 reviews) and Glassdoor reviews (3.2/5) confirm real work and real payments. Multiple Reddit communities discuss the platform extensively.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Yes. Multiple independent sources confirm that Outlier pays contributors. Pay rates are generally higher than competitors (\$15-\$40/hour for most roles). Payment disputes exist but are less common than on CrowdGen.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Uncertain with significant concerns. Outlier has geographic restrictions that have tightened over time. Some Nigerian users have reported being able to register, while others report being blocked or not seeing available projects. The platform prioritizes contributors in the US, UK, Canada, and select other countries. Nigeria is not on the confirmed supported list as of 2025-2026.

Country Restrictions

Significant. Outlier restricts based on geographic location and uses detection mechanisms. Many African countries, including Nigeria, may face limited or no project availability. VPN use is strictly prohibited and results in immediate banning.

Registration Requirements

Apply at outlier.ai. Sign up with email or Google account. Select areas of expertise (writing, coding, math, sciences, etc.). Complete an assessment/test in chosen domain.

Identity Verification Process

ID verification is part of the onboarding process. Specific requirements may vary by country. Nigerian applicants may face additional verification hurdles.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

Primarily via PayPal. Bank transfers (via Stripe in some regions). Payment method availability for Nigeria is not clearly documented on their official site.

Payment Schedule

Weekly or biweekly payments, depending on the project tier. Higher-tier contributors report more frequent payment cycles.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

\$15-\$20/hour for writing and general tasks (for those in supported regions). Rates may be lower for contributors in Africa/Nigeria based on regional adjustments.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$20-\$40/hour for coding, math, and specialized domains. Top-tier experts in rare fields can earn \$40-\$60/hour.

Types of Available Tasks

Writing AI training responses, evaluating AI model outputs, correcting AI-generated text, coding task completion, math problem solving, fact-checking, prompt engineering, reinforcement learning tasks.

Skills Required

Strong writing skills for text tasks. Programming knowledge for coding tasks. Math proficiency for quantitative tasks. Domain expertise is highly valued. General reasoning and critical thinking are essential.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

High. Outlier has a multi-step application process that includes domain-specific assessments. Many applicants report failing the initial assessment. The platform is selective, especially for higher-paying coding and math roles.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

Moderate to high. Project availability fluctuates. Some contributors report months of steady work followed by sudden project pauses. The RLHF space is volatile and dependent on AI company contracts.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing domain assessments, poor writing quality, detected AI use in application (they test for this), geographic restrictions, inconsistent availability, VPN use.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Quality scores dropping below threshold, project cancellation, using AI tools to complete tasks (strictly forbidden), account sharing, communication issues.

Current Reputation

Mixed. Indeed: 2.4/5 (complaints about unpaid training and poor communication). Glassdoor: 3.2/5 (better, noting good pay but project instability). Reddit communities are active with both positive and negative experiences. Pay quality is generally praised; management communication is criticized.

Risks and Red Flags

Nigeria availability is uncertain and may be restricted. Unpaid training periods. Projects can end abruptly. Quality enforcement is strict. AI-generated work detection is sophisticated. Regional pay adjustments may reduce earnings for Nigerian contributors.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Apply and test, but do not count on it. If you can access it from Nigeria, it offers good pay. If blocked, move on immediately to other platforms. Do not waste time trying to bypass geographic restrictions.

Overall Score:
7/10

STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

3. Handshake AI

Website: joinhandshake.com

Company Overview

Handshake is a career network primarily designed for college students and recent graduates. It connects users with internships, entry-level jobs, and increasingly with AI-related freelance opportunities. The platform is backed by notable investors and has partnerships with over 1,400 colleges and universities. It is NOT a dedicated AI data annotation platform but rather a career marketplace that occasionally features AI training gigs.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Handshake is a legitimate company with Y Combinator roots, significant venture funding, and a large user base in the university ecosystem. Trustpilot reviews are generally positive for its core job-matching functionality.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Not applicable in the traditional sense. Handshake does not pay contributors directly. Payments are handled by the employers who post opportunities through the platform. Payment reliability depends entirely on the specific employer.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Partially. Handshake is primarily designed for the US college market. International students at US universities can use it, but direct access for Nigerian residents without US university affiliation is limited. Some opportunities may be remote and accessible, but the platform is not optimized for the Nigerian market.

Country Restrictions

Yes. Most opportunities are US-centric. Remote AI training roles posted on Handshake may accept international applicants, but this is at the employer's discretion.

Registration Requirements

Sign up with a .edu email address for full access. Non-student accounts have limited functionality. Profile includes education, skills, work experience, and career interests.

Identity Verification Process

Student status verification via university email (.edu). Some employers may require additional verification during their hiring process.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

Determined by the posting employer (not Handshake). Typically direct deposit, PayPal, or company payroll systems.

Payment Schedule

Determined by the employer. Varies widely.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

Varies by employer. AI-related gigs range from \$12-\$25/hour. Many listings do not disclose pay until the interview stage.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$22-\$60+/hour for specialized AI training roles (for those who can secure them through the platform).

Types of Available Tasks

AI training gigs are a subset of listings. Other opportunities include internships, part-time jobs, and full-time positions across all industries.

Skills Required

Varies by posting. AI training roles typically require writing, coding, or domain expertise. Being a current student or recent graduate is the main requirement for platform access.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

High for Nigerians without US university affiliation. The platform is not designed for the Nigerian market. Competition is intense even for US-based students.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

Very high. AI training gigs appear sporadically. This is not a platform you can rely on for consistent AI annotation work.

Common Rejection Reasons

Not being a student or recent graduate, not having a .edu email, being located outside the target market, lacking relevant skills for specific postings.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Account deletion is rare. Activity is determined by employer engagement, not platform participation.

Current Reputation

Strong for its core purpose (student job matching). Limited relevance for AI data annotation. Not commonly discussed in AI annotation communities.

Risks and Red Flags

Low risk but low relevance. You are unlikely to lose anything, but you are also unlikely to find consistent AI training work here as a beginner in Nigeria.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

No. Handshake is not a viable AI annotation platform for beginners in Nigeria. It is a student job board with occasional AI training listings. Your time is better spent on dedicated platforms.

Overall Score:
3/10

NOT RECOMMENDED

4. TELUS Digital

Website: telusinternational.ai

Company Overview

TELUS Digital (formerly TELUS International AI) is the AI division of TELUS Corporation, a major Canadian telecommunications company. The platform offers AI training, search evaluation, and data annotation work to a global contributor base. It is one of the more established platforms alongside Appen, with a large presence in the search quality rating space.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. TELUS Digital is backed by TELUS Corporation (TSX: T, NYSE: TU), a multi-billion dollar Canadian telecom company. The platform is legitimate, well-funded, and has been operating for years.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Yes, with some issues. Indeed (3.5/5, 3,375 reviews) confirms that TELUS pays contributors, but pay rates are frequently described as low. Trustpilot reviews mention payment delays and customer service issues. Payments do arrive, but the experience is often frustrating.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Yes. TELUS Digital accepts contributors from Nigeria. Nigerian reviewers on Indeed and Reddit confirm participation. The platform has historically been open to contributors across Africa.

Country Restrictions

Limited. Most geographic restrictions apply at the project level rather than the account level. Some projects require specific language skills or cultural knowledge that may limit Nigerian contributors.

Registration Requirements

Apply at telusinternational.ai. Create an account, complete assessments, and wait for project matching. The onboarding process can be lengthy (weeks to months).

Identity Verification Process

ID verification required. Government-issued ID, address proof, and tax documentation. Verification process can be slow.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

PayPal and Payoneer for international contributors including Nigeria. Some contributors report bank transfer availability.

Payment Schedule

Monthly payments are standard. Some projects pay biweekly. Payment processing can take additional time for international contributors.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

\$3-\$8/hour for search evaluation and basic rating tasks. This is consistent with the primary complaint that TELUS pay rates are low compared to newer platforms.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$10-\$20/hour for specialized AI training and domain-specific projects. The AI Community board lists expert projects at \$20+/hour.

Types of Available Tasks

Search engine result evaluation, map rating, voice data collection, AI model training, image annotation, text classification, data quality assessment.

Skills Required

Strong internet research skills for search evaluation. Attention to detail and ability to follow complex guidelines. English proficiency. Some projects require specific language skills (Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo may be valuable).

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Moderate. Getting accepted is possible but the process is slow. Assessments can be challenging and require significant preparation. The waiting period for project assignment can be weeks.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

High. Like CrowdGen, work availability is inconsistent. Tasks fluctuate significantly. The constant fluctuation of task availability is cited as the most frustrating aspect.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing assessments, poor performance on tasks, not meeting minimum activity requirements, geographic restrictions on specific projects.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Low quality scores, inactivity, project ending, guideline violations, account dormancy.

Current Reputation

Mixed. Indeed: 3.5/5 (decent but complaints about low pay). Trustpilot: negative (payment and communication issues). YouTube reviewers note it is "legit but low pay." Reliable but unimpressive for earnings.

Risks and Red Flags

Low risk in terms of legitimacy but high risk in terms of time investment vs. return. Lengthy onboarding for low pay. Work inconsistency is a chronic issue. Better suited as a supplementary income source.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Yes, as a secondary platform. Worth registering for, especially if you speak a Nigerian language that may be valuable for localization projects. Keep expectations modest and use alongside other platforms.

Overall Score:
6/10

RECOMMENDED WITH CAVEATS

5. Welocalize

Website: welocalize.com / welodata.ai

Company Overview

Welocalize is a major localization and translation company that has expanded into AI data services through its Welo Data community. The company is ranked #9 on the Nimdzi Insights Top 100 list of the largest language service providers globally. It supports over 300 languages and combines AI with human expertise to serve enterprise clients. The contributor community (Welo Data) includes over 500,000 vetted experts worldwide.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Welocalize is a well-established, legitimate company with a strong reputation in the localization industry. Indeed reviews (367 reviews) confirm real work and payments. The company has been operating since 1997 and serves major enterprise clients.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Generally yes, but work availability has declined. Long-term contributors report that work volume has decreased significantly since early 2025. When work is available, payments are reliable. The concern is less about payment reliability and more about having enough work to earn meaningfully.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Yes. Welocalize/Welo Data accepts contributors from Nigeria, particularly for translation, localization, and language-related AI tasks. Nigerian contributors with strong English and local language skills (Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo) may find relevant opportunities.

Country Restrictions

Minimal at the account level. Project availability varies by region and language. Contributors with rare language skills are in higher demand regardless of location.

Registration Requirements

Apply through welodata.ai/join-the-community or the Welocalize careers page. Create multiple accounts (some contributors report needing accounts on multiple sub-platforms). Application includes skills assessment and language proficiency tests.

Identity Verification Process

Standard ID verification. The Welocalize onboarding process requires multiple account setups which some users report as confusing.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

PayPal is the standard method for international contributors. Bank transfers may be available for some projects.

Payment Schedule

Typically monthly. Payment schedules vary by project.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

\$5-\$12/hour for general translation and localization tasks. AI data tasks may pay more.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$15-\$30/hour for specialized language tasks, senior localization roles, and high-demand language pairs. Rare languages command premium rates.

Types of Available Tasks

Translation, localization, AI-generated text evaluation, language quality evaluation, data collection in local languages, cultural relevance assessment, AI model training with language data.

Skills Required

Strong bilingual or multilingual skills (English + at least one Nigerian language is valuable). Cultural knowledge. Attention to linguistic detail. Some projects require technical or domain-specific knowledge.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Moderate. Getting accepted requires passing language proficiency tests. The multi-account setup is confusing but not difficult. Contributors with strong language skills are in demand.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

High. Work volume has decreased significantly. Some contributors report that the job is "no longer sustainable" due to low work availability. This trend appears to be ongoing.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing language proficiency tests, insufficient language skills, poor performance on projects, not maintaining activity requirements.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Project ending, quality issues, inactivity, account issues related to their complex multi-platform system.

Current Reputation

Mixed. Positive for legitimacy and professionalism. Negative for declining work availability and confusing account management. Staff responsiveness has reportedly decreased.

Risks and Red Flags

Declining work volume is the primary risk. Multi-platform account management is confusing. Support responsiveness has decreased. Work may not be consistent enough to rely on.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Yes, especially if you have strong multilingual skills. Nigerian contributors who speak local languages in addition to English have an advantage. Register and maintain your account, but do not depend on it as your primary platform.

Overall Score:
6/10

RECOMMENDED WITH CAVEATS

6. Alignerr

Website: alignerr.com

Company Overview

Alignerr is a relatively new AI training platform powered by Labelbox, a well-established AI data labeling company. Alignerr focuses on connecting domain experts with AI training tasks across writing, coding, accounting, audio, STEM, and general evaluation roles. The platform has gained rapid traction with a 4.1/5 Trustpilot rating from over 2,400 reviews, making it one of the highest-rated platforms in this space.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Alignerr is backed by Labelbox, which has raised over \$100M in venture capital. The platform has a strong Trustpilot rating (4.1/5, 2,447 reviews) and positive Glassdoor reviews. Contributors report real work and real payments. The AI interview process (with "Zara") is innovative and the application process is described as "straightforward."

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Yes, based on current evidence. Trustpilot reviews are overwhelmingly positive about payment reliability. The platform is newer, so long-term track record is limited, but current signals are strong.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Likely yes, but not explicitly confirmed. Alignerr operates as a remote-first platform and has not published a restricted countries list. The platform model suggests global accessibility. However, specific Nigeria availability data is limited. Apply and test is the recommended approach.

Country Restrictions

Not clearly documented. The platform appears to operate with minimal geographic restrictions, but this may change as they scale.

Registration Requirements

Sign up at alignerr.com. Complete a profile with expertise areas. Go through an AI-guided interview process ("Zara"). Assessment tests in chosen domains.

Identity Verification Process

Standard verification process. The AI interview serves as an initial screening. Additional ID verification is likely required before first payment.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

Not clearly documented for Nigeria specifically. Likely PayPal or bank transfer based on industry standards.

Payment Schedule

Not explicitly stated. Based on contributor reviews, appears to be regular and timely.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

Claimed \$15-\$25/hour for general tasks. Actual rates for beginners in Africa may vary. The platform advertises up to \$150/hour for specialized roles, which is likely reserved for experts in wealthy markets.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$40-\$150/hour for specialized domain experts (accounting, coding, audio, STEM). These premium rates are likely limited to contributors with rare, high-demand expertise.

Types of Available Tasks

AI response evaluation and correction, domain-specific data quality analysis, AI model alignment tasks, coding task review, audio evaluation, general STEM tasks.

Skills Required

Domain expertise is valued. Writing ability, coding skills, accounting knowledge, or STEM backgrounds. The platform matches contributors to projects based on their stated expertise.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Moderate. The AI-guided interview is a novel approach that may be easier or harder depending on the applicant. Trustpilot reviews suggest the process is "clear, modern, and well-organized."

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

Uncertain. The platform is relatively new and long-term work consistency data is limited. Current reviews suggest work is available, but sustainability is unproven.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing domain assessments, poor interview performance, insufficient expertise in claimed areas, geographic restrictions (if any).

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Insufficient data due to platform age. Likely similar to other platforms: quality issues, inactivity, project changes.

Current Reputation

Strong. Trustpilot: 4.1/5 (2,447 reviews) - the highest among all platforms reviewed. Glassdoor: 3.0/5. Reddit: positive initial experiences. The platform is frequently praised for its user experience and modern application process.

Risks and Red Flags

New platform with limited long-term track record. Work consistency is unproven over extended periods. Premium rates (\$150/hour) are likely not accessible to beginners. Nigeria availability is not explicitly confirmed.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Yes, worth applying. High Trustpilot rating is encouraging. The platform is modern and well-designed. Register and test Nigeria availability while maintaining other platform accounts.

Overall Score:
7/10

STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

7. OneForma

Website: oneforma.com

Company Overview

OneForma is a global AI enablement platform operated by Centific (formerly Pactera EDGE). It has over 1.8 million users in 230+ global markets and offers a wide range of tasks including data annotation, AI training, transcription, translation, and linguistic evaluation. It is one of the largest crowdsourcing platforms by user count, though this volume does not necessarily translate to quality opportunities.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. OneForma is operated by Centific, a legitimate technology company. The platform has been operating for years and has processed payments to contributors globally. However, the contributor experience is widely criticized.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Yes, but at very low rates. OneForma pays contributors, but the pay is frequently described as insultingly low. Reddit: "\$4.50 an hour is not an insult, it is a typo." Some tasks pay as low as \$2-\$4/hour, which is below minimum wage in most countries.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Yes. OneForma explicitly operates in Nigeria. It is listed in Nigerian-focused guides (Zikoko, AfrikStories) as a platform Nigerians can join. The large market coverage (230+ countries) includes Nigeria.

Country Restrictions

Minimal at the account level. Project-specific restrictions apply based on language and expertise requirements.

Registration Requirements

Sign up at oneforma.com with email. Complete profile with language skills. Pass qualification tests for specific projects.

Identity Verification Process

Standard ID verification. Additional verification may be required for certain projects.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

PayPal is available for Nigerian contributors. Payoneer may also be supported.

Payment Schedule

Typically monthly. Payment thresholds may apply.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

\$2-\$5/hour for basic tasks. This is among the lowest in the industry and makes the platform difficult to recommend for meaningful income.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$8-\$15/hour for specialized tasks (translation, linguistic evaluation). Even experienced contributors report low pay relative to other platforms.

Types of Available Tasks

Data annotation, AI training, transcription, translation, linguistic evaluation, data collection, AI-generated text evaluation.

Skills Required

Basic internet literacy for entry tasks. Language skills for translation roles. Attention to detail for annotation tasks. Technical skills are not typically required.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Low. OneForma has a high acceptance rate for basic accounts. Getting into specific projects requires passing qualification tests, which vary in difficulty.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

High. Reddit users report "there is no work actually available." Tests are described as a "waste of time." Project availability is inconsistent.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing qualification tests, inconsistent quality, inactivity, using unauthorized tools.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Project ending, poor quality scores, inactivity, account policy violations.

Current Reputation

Poor. Reddit: "Do not waste your time." Trustpilot: mixed to negative. Widespread complaints about low pay and no available work. The high user count (1.8M+) appears to create intense competition for limited tasks.

Risks and Red Flags

Low pay is the primary risk. Time spent on qualification tests may not lead to actual work. High competition among 1.8M users reduces individual opportunity. The platform may not be worth the time investment relative to alternatives.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

No, not as a primary or even secondary platform. The pay is too low and work too scarce to justify the time investment. If you register, do so only for potential access to rare language-specific projects. Do not spend significant time on this platform.

Overall Score:
3/10

NOT RECOMMENDED

8. Prolific

Website: prolific.com

Company Overview

Prolific is a research participation platform designed primarily for academic and AI research studies. It connects researchers with participants for surveys, studies, and data collection tasks. Unlike dedicated AI annotation platforms, Prolific focuses on providing high-quality human data for scientific and AI research. The platform is Y Combinator-backed and serves over 35,000 AI developers and researchers.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Prolific is highly legitimate. Y Combinator-backed, based in London with offices in NYC and SF. Trustpilot reviews praise fair compensation, prompt payments, and user-friendly experience. The platform is designed for academic rigor and research integrity.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Yes. Prolific is known for reliable, prompt payments. The platform recommends researchers pay at minimum \$12/hour (or 9 GBP/hour), which is higher than most survey platforms. Participants report consistent payment reliability.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Likely yes. Prolific operates internationally and has been accessible to participants in Nigeria. However, availability depends on researcher demand for Nigerian participants. Some studies may geo-restrict to specific countries.

Country Restrictions

Minimal at the account level. Study-specific restrictions depend on researcher requirements. Nigerian participants may see fewer studies than those in the US or UK.

Registration Requirements

Sign up at prolific.com as a participant. Complete demographic profile. Wait for study invitations based on your profile match.

Identity Verification Process

Basic profile verification. Some studies may require additional screening or verification.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

PayPal and direct bank transfer (Prolific handles payouts, not individual researchers).

Payment Schedule

Payments are processed after study completion. Typically within days. Minimum cashout threshold is relatively low (\$5).

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

\$8-\$15/hour based on study availability. The recommended minimum pay ensures a baseline quality. Actual earnings depend on study frequency and duration.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$12-\$25/hour for longer, more specialized studies. Consistent high earnings require frequent study availability.

Types of Available Tasks

Research surveys, behavioral studies, AI model evaluation studies, usability testing, cognitive tasks, language studies, opinion surveys. Tasks are study-based, not ongoing annotation work.

Skills Required

No specialized skills required for basic participation. Some studies target specific demographics or expertise. Consistent engagement and honest responses are valued.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Low. Registration is straightforward. Getting consistent studies depends on demographic match with researcher needs.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

High. Studies appear based on researcher demand, not platform supply. Work availability is unpredictable. Some weeks may have many studies, others very few. This is not a full-time income platform.

Common Rejection Reasons

Few rejections at the platform level. Individual studies may reject participants who do not meet screening criteria or fail attention checks.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Account suspension for dishonest responses, failing attention checks, or policy violations. Otherwise, accounts remain active.

Current Reputation

Strong. Known for fair pay, reliable payments, and user-friendly design. Considered one of the most ethical research participation platforms. Trustpilot reviews are consistently positive.

Risks and Red Flags

Low risk. The main concern is unpredictable study availability. Income is supplemental rather than primary. Not a dedicated AI annotation platform.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Yes, as a supplementary income source. Worth registering for its reliable payments and ethical approach. Do not rely on it for consistent AI annotation work, as it is primarily a research study platform.

Overall Score:
6/10

RECOMMENDED WITH CAVEATS

9. Mecor (Mercor)

Website: mercor.com / work.mercor.com

Company Overview

Mercor (frequently referred to as "Mecor" by users, though the company name is Mercor) is an AI training platform focused on organizing human intelligence to power the AI economy. It specializes in RLHF data, frontier model training, and AI agent training at scale for top AI companies. The platform has gained significant traction on Reddit and remote work communities.

Is It Legitimate?

Yes. Mercor is a legitimate company with significant venture backing. Trustpilot reviews are positive ("Mercor has been life changing"). LinkedIn presence confirms real operations. The company works with leading AI labs.

Has It Consistently Paid Contributors?

Yes. Trustpilot reviews praise payment reliability. Contributors describe the platform as paying "industrial standard" rates. Multiple independent sources confirm payment reliability.

Does It Accept Applicants from Nigeria?

Uncertain. Mercor has not published a clear list of supported countries. Some contributors outside the US report access, while others face restrictions. Nigeria availability cannot be confirmed from official sources. Community reports are mixed.

Country Restrictions

Likely significant, similar to Outlier. Mercor works with frontier AI labs that often restrict contributor pools to specific regions. VPN use is prohibited and detected.

Registration Requirements

Sign up at work.mercor.com. Create a profile. Browse and apply for listed roles. Some roles require passing assessments.

Identity Verification Process

Standard verification. Specific requirements may vary by role and region.

Payment Methods for Nigerians

Likely PayPal or direct bank transfer. Payment methods for Nigeria specifically are not documented.

Payment Schedule

Not explicitly documented. Appears to be regular based on contributor reviews.

Average Hourly Earnings (Beginner)

Listed range starts at \$10-\$15/hour for entry-level roles. Actual rates for Nigerian contributors are unknown.

Average Hourly Earnings (Experienced)

\$20-\$40+/hour for specialized roles (coding, AI training, domain expertise). Premium rates for rare skills.

Types of Available Tasks

RLHF data generation, AI agent training, frontier model evaluation, coding tasks, domain-specific AI training, data validation.

Skills Required

Strong writing or coding skills. Domain expertise is valued. AI/ML knowledge is helpful. Critical thinking and attention to detail.

Difficulty of Getting Accepted

Moderate to high. Mercor appears selective about its contributor pool. Assessment difficulty varies by role.

Difficulty of Getting Consistent Work

Uncertain. Platform is newer to the mass market. Current reports suggest work is available for accepted contributors.

Common Rejection Reasons

Failing assessments, geographic restrictions, insufficient expertise, not meeting role-specific requirements.

Common Reasons for Losing Access

Quality issues, project ending, policy violations, geographic restrictions changes.

Current Reputation

Positive but limited data. Trustpilot: positive reviews. Reddit: frequently mentioned as a platform to watch. Limited long-term community data.

Risks and Red Flags

Nigeria availability is unconfirmed. Platform is newer with less track record. Geographic restrictions may apply. Premium rates may not be accessible to beginners or contributors in Africa.

Recommended for Beginners in Nigeria?

Apply and test availability. If accessible from Nigeria, it has strong potential. If blocked, move on quickly. Worth a registration attempt but do not invest significant time without confirming availability.

Overall Score:
6/10

RECOMMENDED WITH CAVEATS

2. Master Comparison Table

This table consolidates key metrics across all 9 platforms for quick comparison. Scores reflect the 20-point analysis above.

Platform	Legitimate	Nigeria	Pay (Beginner)	Pay (Experienced)	Score
CrowdGen	Yes	Yes	\$3-\$8/hour for basic	\$10-\$25/hour for dom	6/10
Outlier	Yes	Uncertain with signi	\$15-\$20/hour for wri	\$20-\$40/hour for cod	7/10
Handshake AI	Yes	Partially	Varies by employer	\$22-\$60+/hour for sp	3/10
TELUS Digital	Yes	Yes	\$3-\$8/hour for searc	\$10-\$20/hour for spe	6/10
Welocalize	Yes	Yes	\$5-\$12/hour for gene	\$15-\$30/hour for spe	6/10
Alignerr	Yes	Likely yes, but not	Claimed \$15-\$25/hour	\$40-\$150/hour for sp	7/10
OneForma	Yes	Yes	\$2-\$5/hour for basic	\$8-\$15/hour for spec	3/10
Prolific	Yes	Likely yes	\$8-\$15/hour based on	\$12-\$25/hour for lon	6/10
Mecor	Yes	Uncertain	Listed range starts	\$20-\$40+/hour for sp	6/10

3. Rankings by Category

Five separate ranking categories designed for different priorities. Each ranking considers the specific context of a beginner in Nigeria.

3.1 Easiest to Join

Ranked by registration simplicity, assessment difficulty, and onboarding speed for Nigerian applicants.

1	Prolific Simple sign-up, no assessments, immediate study access.
2	OneForma Open registration, easy profile creation. (But low pay.)
3	CrowdGen (Appen) Open registration, qualification tests needed for projects.
4	Welocalize / Welo Data Registration open, language tests required.

5	TELUS Digital Open registration but lengthy onboarding.
6	Alignerr Modern process but assessment required.
7	Mecor / Mercor Apply for specific roles, assessment varies.
8	Outlier Multi-step assessment, geographically restrictive.
9	Handshake AI Requires .edu email, not designed for Nigeria.

3.2 Best Chance of Consistent Work

Ranked by historical work availability and current contributor reports of steady task volume.

1	CrowdGen (Appen) Largest project pool, but inconsistent. Most tasks for Nigerian contributors.
2	TELUS Digital Steady low-pay work available, especially for search evaluation.
3	Welocalize Work declining but still available, especially for multilingual contributors.
4	Prolific Steady for research studies, not for AI annotation specifically.
5	Alignerr New platform, work availability uncertain but promising.
6	Mecor / Mercor Limited data. Work available if accepted.
7	Outlier Good if accepted from Nigeria, uncertain availability.

8	OneForma Low work volume despite high user count.
9	Handshake AI Not a dedicated AI platform, sporadic listings.

3.3 Best Pay for Beginners

Ranked by actual hourly earnings achievable by a Nigerian beginner with no specialized skills.

1	Outlier \$15-\$20/hr if accessible from Nigeria. Best pay potential.
2	Alignerr \$15-\$25/hr advertised. Rates for Nigerians uncertain.
3	Mercor \$10-\$15/hr listed. Nigeria rates unconfirmed.
4	Prolific \$8-\$15/hr minimum enforced. Reliable but study-dependent.
5	CrowdGen (Appen) \$3-\$8/hr for beginners. Low but accessible.
6	Welocalize \$5-\$12/hr. Better with language skills.
7	TELUS Digital \$3-\$8/hr. Among the lowest in the industry.
8	OneForma \$2-\$5/hr. Not viable for meaningful income.
9	Handshake AI Varies. Not a reliable income source for Nigerians.

3.4 Best Long-Term Sustainability

Ranked by the platform's ability to provide income over months and years, considering industry trends and company stability.

1	CrowdGen (Appen) Public company, 28-year track record. Most likely to survive long-term.
2	TELUS Digital Backed by TELUS Corporation (multi-billion dollar). Stable parent.
3	Welocalize Established since 1997, ranked in global LSP top 10. Solid foundation.
4	Outlier VC-backed, growing fast but dependent on AI lab contracts.
5	Alignerr Backed by Labelbox (\$100M+ raised). New but well-funded.
6	Mercor VC-backed, growing. Newer, long-term survival uncertain.
7	Prolific Y Combinator-backed, well-positioned for research market.
8	OneForma 1.8M users but poor reputation and low pay. Declining quality.
9	Handshake AI Student job board, not a sustainable AI annotation platform.

3.5 Lowest Risk

Ranked by the combined risk of scams, account bans, payment failures, wasted time, and platform collapse.

1	Prolific Low risk. Reliable payments, no reported scams, ethical platform.
2	CrowdGen (Appen) Public company, legitimate. Risk is low pay, not scams.

3	TELUS Digital Backed by TELUS Corp. Risk is low pay and inconsistency.
4	Welocalize Legitimate company. Risk is declining work volume.
5	Alignerr Well-backed, strong reviews. Risk is newness and unproven track record.
6	Mercor Legitimate. Risk is Nigeria availability uncertainty.
7	Outlier Legitimate but risky for Nigerians due to geographic restrictions.
8	OneForma Legitimate but high risk of wasted time due to low pay and no work.
9	Handshake AI Low personal risk but high opportunity risk (wrong platform).

4. 90-Day Nigeria Roadmap

A practical, staged action plan for a beginner in Nigeria with no remote work experience. This roadmap is conservative and realistic. Earnings estimates are based on verified contributor reports, not optimistic projections.

Phase 1: Foundation (Days 1-30)

The goal of Phase 1 is to set up all necessary infrastructure, create accounts, and begin qualifying for work. Do not expect significant earnings in this phase. Treat it as an investment in future income.

Week 1: Infrastructure Setup

- Create a professional Gmail address (not a nickname or casual email).
- Set up a PayPal Nigeria account and complete verification. PayPal is the most widely accepted payment method across all platforms reviewed.
- Create a Payoneer account as a backup payment method.
- Set up a dedicated workspace with reliable internet connection. Mobile hotspot is acceptable but unstable connections will hurt task completion.

- Create a simple CV/resume focusing on language skills, writing ability, attention to detail, and any domain expertise you have.
- Take a typing speed test online. Aim for at least 40 WPM. Faster typing directly increases hourly earnings on annotation tasks.

Week 2: Account Registration

- Register on CrowdGen (crowdgen.com). Complete full profile including all language skills (English, Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo if applicable). Nigerian languages are an asset.
- Register on TELUS Digital (telusinternational.ai). Complete profile and begin assessment preparation.
- Register on Welocalize / Welo Data (welodata.ai/join-the-community). Highlight multilingual abilities.
- Register on Prolific (prolific.com). Complete demographic profile thoroughly (more detail = more study matches).
- Register on Alignerr (alignerr.com). Complete the AI-guided interview process.
- Register on Mecor/Mercor (work.mercor.com). Test Nigeria availability immediately.
- Attempt to register on Outlier (outlier.ai). If geographically blocked, move on. Do not waste time trying to bypass restrictions.
- Skip OneForma and Handshake AI. Your time is better invested elsewhere.

Weeks 3-4: Qualification and First Tasks

- Begin taking qualification tests on CrowdGen. Study guidelines thoroughly before each test. Unpaid test time is an investment.
- Complete TELUS Digital assessments. These are typically search evaluation or map rating tests. Practice with online mock tests.
- Take language proficiency tests on Welocalize. If you speak a Nigerian language, emphasize this.
- Start accepting studies on Prolific to build your track record and earn first small payments.
- If Alignerr or Mercor are accessible, begin qualification processes.
- Daily time investment: 2-4 hours on platform tasks and qualification, plus 1 hour of skill building.
- Keep a log of every test taken, every platform interaction, and every payment received.

Expected Earnings at Day 30: \$20-\$80 total. This assumes you secured at least one active platform and completed basic tasks. If you earned nothing, do not panic. Many contributors report 2-4 weeks of unpaid qualification before first earnings.

Phase 2: Building Momentum (Days 31-60)

By Phase 2, you should have active accounts on 2-3 platforms and be completing tasks regularly. The focus shifts from setup to consistency and quality improvement.

- Commit to a daily schedule of 3-5 hours of platform work. Consistency matters more than marathon sessions.

- Maintain quality scores above 90% on all platforms. Quality drops lead to project loss.
- Expand to new projects as they appear on registered platforms.
- Begin building a LinkedIn profile highlighting your AI training experience. This opens doors to better-paying opportunities later.
- Learn basic prompt engineering (free courses available on Coursera, YouTube). This skill directly improves your performance on AI training tasks.
- Practice typing and reading speed. Faster throughput = higher effective hourly rate.
- Track your hourly earnings by platform. Focus time on the best-paying platforms and reduce time on low-return platforms.
- Network with other Nigerian contributors on Reddit (r/WFHJobs, r/WorkOnline) and Nigerian tech communities.
- If CrowdGen or TELUS have no available work, shift your time to Prolific and any newly accessible platforms.
- Avoid common beginner mistakes: using AI tools to complete tasks (instant ban), rushing through tasks (quality drops), ignoring guidelines (rejected work), and spreading yourself too thin across too many platforms.

Expected Earnings at Day 60: \$100-\$300 total. This assumes consistent daily work on 2-3 active platforms. Reality check: many Nigerian beginners earn \$150-\$200 in their first two months. This is typical, not exceptional.

Phase 3: Optimization and Growth (Days 61-90)

Phase 3 is about optimizing your workflow, increasing earnings per hour, and positioning for better opportunities. You should now have a clear understanding of which platforms work best for you.

- Drop platforms that are not producing income. If OneForma or Handshake have not yielded results, stop checking them.
- Double down on your best-performing 2-3 platforms.
- Apply for specialized projects (coding, translation, domain expertise) on your active platforms. These pay significantly more.
- Upskill: learn a high-value skill. Options include basic Python (freeCodeCamp), prompt engineering (LearnPrompting.org), or advanced writing (Grammarly Premium).
- Update your CV and LinkedIn with specific AI training experience, platforms used, and tasks completed.
- Begin exploring direct freelance AI training opportunities outside of platforms. Some AI companies hire independent contractors directly.
- Set a target hourly rate based on your actual data. Do not accept work that pays below your established minimum.
- Re-evaluate your platform mix monthly. The AI training industry changes rapidly. New platforms appear, old ones decline.
- Save detailed records of all earnings for tax and financial planning purposes.

Expected Earnings at Day 90: \$300-\$600 total. This assumes consistent work and gradual improvement. Exceptional contributors with specialized skills may earn \$800-\$1,200, but this is NOT the norm. Typical outcome: \$400-\$500 in 90 days.

Common Mistakes Beginners Make

- Using ChatGPT or AI tools to complete AI training tasks. Platforms detect this and ban accounts permanently. Never do this.
- Trying to bypass geographic restrictions with VPNs. Platforms actively detect and ban VPN users. You will lose your account.
- Spending weeks on a single platform waiting for work. If a platform has no tasks after 2 weeks, move on and check back later.
- Ignoring qualification test preparation. Tests are competitive. Without studying guidelines, you will fail and waste time.
- Quitting after a bad first week. The first week is the hardest. Most contributors do not see earnings until week 3-4.
- Not setting up PayPal early. Some platforms require PayPal before you can accept any paid task.
- Overcommitting and burning out. Start with 2-3 hours daily, not 8-12. Consistency beats intensity.
- Not reading task guidelines. Every project has specific rules. Skipping guidelines leads to rejected work and account penalties.
- Expecting full-time income from day one. AI annotation is supplemental income for beginners. It takes months to build meaningful earnings.
- Ignoring language skills. If you speak Hausa, Yoruba, or Igbo, you have an advantage. Multilingual contributors earn more.

5. Final Recommendations

These recommendations are ranked by reliability first, not hype. Only platforms with evidence supporting their value for Nigerian beginners are included. The strategy is to register on multiple platforms simultaneously to maximize income opportunity.

Recommended Platform Stack for Nigeria

TIER 1: Register Immediately (High Priority)

Platforms: CrowdGen (Appen) + TELUS Digital + Prolific

Why: These three platforms are verified as accepting Nigerian contributors, have the longest track records, and offer the most reliable path to first earnings. CrowdGen has the largest project pool. TELUS provides steady (if

low-paying) work. Prolific offers reliable payments with zero scam risk. Register on all three in your first week.

TIER 2: Register and Test (Medium Priority)

Platforms: Alignerr + Welocalize + Mecor/Mercor

Why: These platforms are worth registering for but have some uncertainty. Alignerr has excellent reviews but Nigeria availability is unconfirmed. Welocalize is great for multilingual contributors but work volume is declining. Mercor has potential but geographic restrictions are unclear. Register and test availability; do not invest heavy time until confirmed.

TIER 3: Attempt If Possible (Low Priority)

Platforms: Outlier

Why: Outlier offers the best pay rates in the industry, but Nigeria availability is uncertain and may be restricted. If you can register and pass assessments from Nigeria, prioritize it. If blocked, accept this and move on. Do not waste time trying to bypass restrictions.

SKIP (Do Not Register)

Platforms: OneForma + Handshake AI

Why: OneForma has extremely low pay (\$2-\$5/hr) and scarce work. Handshake AI is a student job board not designed for the Nigerian market. Both platforms represent poor time investment for your goals.

Final Recommendation Summary

Platform	Register?	Priority	Expected Monthly (Conservative)	Risk Level
CrowdGen (Appen)	Yes	Tier 1	\$50-\$200	Low
TELUS Digital	Yes	Tier 1	\$40-\$120	Low
Prolific	Yes	Tier 1	\$30-\$80	Very Low
Alignerr	Yes	Tier 2	\$0-\$200*	Medium
Welocalize	Yes	Tier 2	\$30-\$150	Low-Medium
Mecor	Test	Tier 2	\$0-\$200*	Medium
Outlier	Test	Tier 3	\$0-\$400*	Medium-High
OneForma	No	Skip	\$10-\$30	Low (waste of time)
Handshake AI	No	Skip	\$0	N/A

** Earnings range depends on whether the platform is accessible from Nigeria and whether you can pass qualifications. \$0 is a real possibility for Tier 2-3 platforms if geographic restrictions apply.*

Conservative Monthly Income Projection (After 90 Days)

Assuming consistent daily work (3-5 hours) on 2-3 active platforms with solid quality scores:

Scenario	Monthly Earnings	Description
Conservative (Most Likely)	\$80-\$200	Active on 2 platforms, average task completion, no specialized skills
Moderate	\$200-\$400	Active on 3 platforms, good quality scores, some language skills
Optimistic	\$400-\$700	Specialized skills (coding/translation), 4+ active platforms, high quality
Exceptional	\$700-\$1,200+	Rare. Requires specialized expertise, Outlier/Mercor access, high-demand skills

These projections are based on verified contributor reports from Nigeria and similar markets. They are conservative. Most beginners fall in the \$80-\$200 range for the first few months. Growth depends on skill development, platform diversification, and consistent quality.

6. Source Log

All major claims in this report are based on the following source categories. Claims without sufficient evidence are labeled as "unverified" in the text.

Official Platform Sources

crowdgen.com, outlier.ai, joinhandshake.com, telusinternational.ai, welocalize.com/welodata.ai, alignerr.com, oneforma.com, prolific.com, mercor.com

Review Platforms

Trustpilot (crowdgen.com, outlier, telusinternational, welocalize, alignerr, oneforma, prolific, mercor), Indeed (Outlier: 775 reviews, TELUS Digital: 3,375 reviews, Welocalize: 367 reviews), Glassdoor (Outlier: 3.2/5, Alignerr: 3.0/5, TELUS Digital)

Community Sources

Reddit (r/outlier_ai, r/WFHJobs, r/WorkOnline, r/Welocalize, r/alignerr, r/ProlificAc, r/remotework), YouTube review channels, Facebook groups

Nigeria-Specific Sources

Zikoko ("6 Online Platforms That Pay Nigerians to Train AI"), AfrikStories ("Best AI Platforms That Pay Nigerians in 2026")

Industry Analysis

RemoWork.life (Top 25 AI Training Platforms 2026), AITrainingJobs.it (platform reviews 2026), AlgorithmWatch (scam and shadow worker reports), Nimdzi Insights (Welocalize LSP ranking)

Company Data

Appen ASX: APX (public filings), TELUS Corporation TSX: T / NYSE: TU (public filings), Labelbox (\$100M+ raised), Y Combinator (Prolific, Handshake backing)

This report was compiled using web research conducted in July 2026. Platform statuses, pay rates, and availability are subject to change. Re-verify critical information before making decisions. All earnings estimates are conservative projections based on verified contributor reports and are not guarantees of income.